

SUSHIL KANUBHAI SHAH

60, HEALTHCARE PROVIDER
CHAIRMAN, METROPOLIS
HEALTH SERVICES
TURNOVER IN 1981 Rs 2 lakh
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 150 crore

PATHWAY TO GLORY

At 18, when Sushil Kanubhai Shah decided to study pathology at Mumbai's Grant Medical College, he was foraying into an industry in its nascent stage. Pathology labs were still a one-man business, all tests were done manually and laboratories depended largely on the availability of a single doctor. Unlike the tiny rooms in large hospitals where pathological tests are performed, Shah's Metropolis Health Services India Ltd, which he started in 1981 with just Rs 2 lakh, became a frontrunner in carrying out specialised tests—some that even leading hospitals didn't offer. By the time he rechristened Dr Sushil Shah's Laboratories as Metropolis Health Services India Ltd in 1994, Shah was already responsible for setting up India's first referral lab for specialised tests—like the radio immunoassay to test malignancy, infertility and pregnancy problems.

Metropolis processes over one crore specialised tests in a year. Some highly specialised tests that can be conducted at the Metropolis laboratories are the HIV drug resistance tests, which they introduced in India, and the nephelometry technique for the estimation of plasma proteins. Conducted on imported machinery from Europe and the US, Metropolis also offers specialised services like immunohistochemistry, used for diagnosis of abnormal cells such as those found in cancerous tumors, histopathology and neuropathology tests to diagnose diseased cells.

With 27 years of experience in conducting tests and delivering reports, Metropolis has earned the reputation of being India's only multinational chain of diagnostic centres with a presence in the UAE, Seychelles, Sri Lanka, Thailand and South Africa. At these destinations, Shah found that the existing health services infrastructure was



**SHAH'S PATHOLOGY
LABS HAVE THE
SINGULAR**

**DISTINCTION OF
CONDUCTING
3,700 KINDS OF
TESTS AT ITS
MUMBAI CENTRE
AND DESIGNING
NEARLY 600
NEW TESTS
EVERY YEAR.**

poor, with no lab chains like Metropolis. Yet profit margins were higher. The company now caters to more than 10,000 laboratories, hospitals, nursing homes and 20,000 consultants. It has 50 labs across the country, 17 in other countries and over 350 collection centres across the globe, with international laboratories accounting for